

Assume that today's date is 7 January 2023. You are a hospital nephrologist and you have been supervising a patient on the dialysis unit for the three months

NAME: Mr Trevor Evans .

D.O.B: 26/NOV /1945

Retired Bank clerk.

Married, Main carer of wife (has COPD).

No children

Interests gaming , vintage motorbikes.

Family history: father died 65 y.o (liver cancer).

Mother dies 52 y.o (stroke)

Medical history : Feb 2017 fracture L ankle and scapula .

May 2018 type 2 Diabetes mellitus diag

Medications: Metformin 500 mg /day (diabetes)

Hospital treatment record:

10 Sep 2022: presented at hospital emergency department with shortness of breath, chest pain, sweating . fever (39.2)

Pneumonia diag: amoxicillin 500 mg 1x/8hrs

Pt transferred to ward.

11 sep 22: onset of slurred speech, mottled skin, hypotension, anuria, headaches, nausea.

Septic shock diag: IV fluids ,broad spectrum antibiotic.

Acute kidney injury diag: haemodialysis 4 hrs 3x/wk. to commence 12sep

Metformin ceased - replaced with insulin , medication management by multidisciplinary hospital team

15 Oct 2022: pt stable -pneumonia and sepsis resolved .

Pt ready to transfer to sub -acute rehabilitation facility.

No improvement in renal function.

02Nov 2022: PT stable and ready for discharge

Dialysis to continue (4hrs3x/wk- dialysis unit).

Carer visit arranged 2x/wk) support pt and wife at home.

Hospital kidney dialysis unit treatment record (extracts):

21Dec 2022 discussion - dialysis nurse and pt.

Pt concerns:

Worry re indefinite continuation dialysis ..low mood .

Fatigue and loss of energy

Sense of worthlessness.

22 Dec 2022: Nephrology team meeting:

Concern reported by dialysis nurse re Pts symptoms - consistent with depression

Mirtazapine antidepressant) prescribed -5mg /day.

Review with nephrologist 07 Jan.

07 Jan 2023: Nephrologist review.

Pt reports increased symptoms of depression (insufficiency of mirtazapine), guilt , reduced ability to care for wife .

Doctor at patients medical practice to assess mental health , onward referral for counseling. pt agreed to make appointment as soon as possible and consent obtained for letter to doctor

Plan: write to patients doctor.

Writing task:

Using the information give in the case notes , write a letter to Dr Imre , the patient's doctor , outlining your concerns and the reasons for them ,and requesting further assessment . Address the letter to Dr Jason Imre . Newton Medical Practice Newton.